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SET - I

Q1. Define Marketing. What are the features of marketing?

Ans :- DEFINITION AND KEY FEATURES OF MARKETING

➤ **Meaning of Marketing**

Marketing is the process of identifying, anticipating, and satisfying customer needs profitably. It encompasses all activities involved in promoting, selling, and distributing a product or service to the target market. Marketing is not merely about selling products; it involves understanding consumer behaviour, creating value, and establishing long-term relationships with customers. The essence of marketing lies in creating demand, delivering value, and achieving customer satisfaction through innovation and strategic communication.

➤ **Definition of Marketing**

According to the **American Marketing Association (AMA)**, “Marketing is the activity, set of institutions, and processes for creating, communicating, delivering, and exchanging offerings that have value for customers, clients, partners, and society at large.”

In simpler terms, marketing refers to the management process through which goods and services move from concept to customer, ensuring that both business and consumer goals are met efficiently.

➤ **Features of Marketing**

I. Customer Orientation

- The fundamental principle of marketing is customer satisfaction.
- All marketing activities — from product design to after-sales service — focus on fulfilling customer needs and preferences.
- For example, Apple constantly studies consumer expectations to design products that align with changing lifestyles and technology trends.

II. Exchange Process

- Marketing involves an exchange where customers obtain products or services in return for money or other forms of value.

- It is a mutually beneficial process that satisfies both parties.
- Effective marketing ensures smooth and transparent transactions.

III. Value Creation

- The aim of marketing is to create and deliver superior value to customers.
- Companies achieve this by improving product quality, offering competitive prices, and enhancing the buying experience.
- Brands like Amazon and Nike focus on delivering consistent value that fosters customer loyalty.

IV. Integrated Approach

- Marketing is an integrated process involving product, price, place, and promotion — known as the **4 Ps** of marketing.
- Coordination between departments such as production, finance, and sales ensures efficiency.
- A well-integrated strategy results in brand consistency and customer trust.

V. Goal-Oriented Activity

- Every marketing activity aims to achieve business objectives such as increased sales, market share, and profitability.
- At the same time, it ensures customer satisfaction, brand recognition, and long-term growth.

VI. Continuous Process

- Marketing is a dynamic and continuous process that evolves with market trends, consumer preferences, and technological changes.
- Regular analysis and feedback help businesses adapt to changing market conditions.

VII. Environmental Influence

- Marketing decisions are influenced by external factors like economic conditions, government policies, technology, and competition.
- Businesses must constantly monitor the environment to remain relevant and competitive.

VIII. Relationship Building

- Modern marketing focuses on developing long-term relationships with customers through trust and consistent engagement.

- Relationship marketing enhances brand loyalty and customer retention.

IX. Utility Creation

- Marketing creates different types of utility such as form utility (product design), place utility (availability at convenient locations), time utility (availability when needed), and possession utility (ease of purchase).
- Together, these utilities ensure that the product delivers maximum satisfaction to customers.

X. Innovation and Adaptability

- Marketing encourages innovation in product design, promotion techniques, and delivery systems.
- Successful firms innovate continuously to keep pace with evolving consumer demands and market trends.

Conclusion

Marketing plays a pivotal role in the success of any business. It not only focuses on selling products but also on creating value, building relationships, and satisfying customer needs. The key features — such as customer orientation, value creation, integration, and innovation — make marketing an indispensable part of organisational strategy. In today's competitive environment, effective marketing helps organisations build strong brands, sustain profitability, and adapt to the ever-changing global marketplace.

Q2. List the 7 P's of Marketing. Explain any three of them.

Ans :- UNDERSTANDING THE 7 P's OF MARKETING AND THEIR STRATEGIC IMPORTANCE

➤ Meaning of the 7 P's of Marketing

The **7 P's of Marketing**, also known as the **Extended Marketing Mix**, represent a comprehensive framework used by organisations to design, implement, and evaluate effective marketing strategies. Initially, marketing was based on four key elements — Product, Price, Place, and Promotion. However, to address the growing complexity of services and customer relationships, three additional elements — People, Process, and Physical Evidence — were introduced. Together, these seven elements help businesses align their offerings with customer expectations and competitive market dynamics.

➤ The 7 P's of Marketing

- I. Product
- II. Price
- III. Place
- IV. Promotion
- V. People
- VI. Process
- VII. Physical Evidence

➤ Explanation of Any Three P's

I. Product

- The product is the foundation of the marketing mix. It refers to the tangible goods or intangible services offered to satisfy customer needs and preferences.
- Product decisions involve aspects like design, quality, packaging, branding, and after-sales services.
- A well-designed product addresses customer pain points and differentiates the business from competitors.
- For example, **Apple's iPhone** stands out due to its premium design, advanced features, and consistent brand value, creating customer loyalty and market dominance.

II. Price

- Price is the monetary value that customers pay to acquire a product or service. It plays a vital role in determining the perceived value and positioning of the offering in the market.
- Pricing strategies can vary — such as penetration pricing (low price to gain market share), skimming (high initial price), or competitive pricing.
- A well-balanced pricing strategy ensures profitability while maintaining customer satisfaction and competitiveness.
- For instance, **Netflix** uses flexible pricing tiers that cater to different customer segments, ensuring affordability and accessibility.

III. Promotion

- Promotion encompasses all communication strategies used to inform, persuade, and remind customers about the product.

- It includes advertising, sales promotions, personal selling, public relations, and digital marketing.
- The main objective is to create awareness, generate interest, and influence buying behaviour.
- For example, **Coca-Cola** runs global advertising campaigns that emotionally connect with audiences through storytelling and consistent brand messaging.

➤ Significance of the 7 P's in Marketing

- The 7 P's help businesses create a balanced marketing strategy that focuses on both tangible and intangible aspects of customer value.
- They ensure that every marketing decision aligns with organisational goals, customer needs, and competitive realities.
- In service-oriented industries such as hospitality or healthcare, factors like **People**, **Process**, and **Physical Evidence** play a crucial role in building trust and credibility.

Conclusion

The 7 P's of Marketing form the backbone of an effective marketing strategy. Each element — from product development to customer experience — contributes to overall brand success and customer satisfaction. By effectively managing these components, organisations can enhance value creation, strengthen their market position, and achieve long-term growth in an increasingly competitive business environment.

Q3. Define Segmentation. List the Steps in Segmentation.

Ans :- UNDERSTANDING MARKET SEGMENTATION AND ITS STRATEGIC STEPS

➤ Meaning of Market Segmentation

Market segmentation is the process of dividing a broad market into smaller, more homogeneous groups of consumers who share similar characteristics, preferences, or needs. This approach allows businesses to design and execute targeted marketing strategies that cater to the specific requirements of each segment. By segmenting the market, organisations can use their resources efficiently, develop customised products, and enhance customer satisfaction and retention.

➤ Importance of Market Segmentation

- It helps in identifying and understanding the needs of different customer groups.

- It enables effective targeting and positioning strategies.
- It assists in optimising marketing resources and improving profitability.
- It fosters long-term customer relationships through personalisation.

➤ **Steps in Market Segmentation**

I. Identify the Market and Define Objectives

- The first step is to clearly define the overall market and the purpose of segmentation.
- The organisation must determine whether the segmentation is aimed at introducing new products, repositioning existing ones, or improving communication strategies.
- For example, a company entering the electric vehicle market may segment customers based on income, environmental awareness, and usage patterns.

II. Determine the Basis of Segmentation

- Segmentation can be based on different criteria such as demographic, geographic, psychographic, and behavioural factors.
- Demographic factors include age, gender, income, and education.
- Psychographic segmentation considers lifestyle, personality, and values.
- Behavioural segmentation focuses on purchasing habits, loyalty, and product usage.

III. Develop Market Segments

- Once the criteria are chosen, customers are grouped into distinct segments that share similar characteristics.
- Each segment must be measurable, substantial, accessible, and actionable.
- For instance, a smartphone brand may create segments like budget-conscious users, tech enthusiasts, and business professionals.

IV. Evaluate the Market Segments

- Each segment must be assessed for its size, growth potential, profitability, and competitive intensity.
- Businesses must identify which segments align best with their capabilities and market goals.
- Evaluation helps in selecting the most attractive and sustainable segments.

V. Select the Target Segment

- After evaluation, companies select the most viable segments to focus on.
- Targeting strategies can be undifferentiated (same approach for all), differentiated (unique approach for each), or concentrated (focus on one segment).
- For example, luxury brands like Rolex use a concentrated targeting strategy focused on premium customers.

VI. Design and Implement the Marketing Mix

- The marketing mix (Product, Price, Place, Promotion) must be customised for the selected segments.
- This ensures that the marketing strategy resonates with the segment's needs and preferences.

VII. Monitor and Review Segmentation Strategy

- Market conditions and consumer behaviours evolve over time.
- Regular evaluation helps ensure the segmentation strategy remains effective and relevant.
- Adjustments may be required to maintain competitiveness.

Conclusion

Market segmentation is a vital tool that enables businesses to understand their customers deeply and serve them more effectively. By following a structured process — from identifying the market to implementing and reviewing the strategy — organisations can enhance customer satisfaction and achieve long-term profitability. Effective segmentation not only drives marketing efficiency but also strengthens the brand's position in a dynamic marketplace.

SET - II

Q4. List the methods of pricing. Explain any 3 of them

Ans :- METHODS OF PRICING AND EXPLANATION OF THREE KEY METHODS

➤ Meaning of Pricing

Pricing is the managerial process of assigning a monetary value to a product or service to capture customer value, cover costs, and achieve organisational objectives such as profit, market share, or positioning.

➤ Methods of Pricing (List)

Cost-plus pricing, markup pricing, target-return pricing, marginal (incremental) pricing, absorption-cost pricing, value-based pricing, competition/going-rate pricing, tender/sealed-bid pricing, skimming pricing, penetration pricing, psychological pricing, bundle pricing, dynamic (surge/yield) pricing, geographic pricing, discriminatory/segmented pricing, premium pricing, economy pricing, freemium and two-part tariff pricing.

➤ Explanation of Any Three Methods

I. Cost-Plus Pricing

- Definition: Price is computed by adding a fixed markup to unit cost (variable cost + allocated fixed cost).
- Rationale: Ensures full cost recovery and a predictable profit margin; simple to administer and justify internally.
- Suitable When: Demand is stable, cost data are reliable, and price transparency is acceptable (e.g., industrial components, government contracts).
- Caveats: Ignores customer willingness to pay and competitor moves; risks overpricing in weak demand and underpricing when demand is strong.

II. Value-Based Pricing

- Definition: Price is set primarily on the perceived value to the customer rather than on the seller's cost.
- Rationale: Captures a fair share of created value by linking price to outcomes, savings, or

experiences delivered (e.g., time saved, risk reduced).

- **Suitable When:** Differentiation is strong, benefits are measurable, and segments can be educated about economic value (software, medical devices, B2B solutions).
- **Implementation Keys:** Conduct economic value estimation, segment by willingness to pay, use proof points (case results, ROI calculators).
- **Caveats:** Requires robust customer insight and credible communication; misjudging value can depress demand.

III. Penetration Pricing

- **Definition:** Launching at a deliberately low price to quickly build volume, attract trial, and discourage rivals.
- **Rationale:** Exploits price elasticity, accelerates network effects and learning curves, and raises entry barriers for competitors.
- **Suitable When:** Market is price sensitive, economies of scale are significant, and rapid adoption is strategic (consumer tech, platforms, FMCG).
- **Execution Keys:** Time-bound introductory prices, clear upgrade paths, vigilant cost control to protect margins as volumes rise.
- **Caveats:** Risk of a “cheap” quality signal; difficult to raise prices later without added value or tiering.

➤ Significance for Managers

- Align pricing choice with positioning, elasticity, cost structure, and competitive intensity.
- Blend methods tactically (e.g., value-based list price with promotional bundles) while maintaining coherent brand signals.

Conclusion

An informed pricing strategy starts with a full toolbox and ends with disciplined choice. Cost-plus safeguards margins, value-based captures willingness to pay, and penetration accelerates scale. The best managers align method to market conditions, articulate value clearly, and iterate using data, thereby turning price into a durable source of competitive advantage.

Q5. Define Publicity. List the types of advertising with example.

Ans :- MEANING OF PUBLICITY AND TYPES OF ADVERTISING WITH EXAMPLES

➤ **Meaning of Publicity**

Publicity refers to a **non-paid form of communication** aimed at promoting or influencing public perception about a product, service, or organisation. It involves disseminating information through media outlets, public events, or social discussions without direct payment by the company.

It plays a key role in shaping public opinion, building credibility, and enhancing brand visibility. Since publicity comes from independent sources like news agencies or social media, it is perceived as more trustworthy than paid advertisements.

➤ **Importance of Publicity**

I. Publicity helps in **creating awareness** about the organisation's activities or new product launches.

II. It enhances **brand image** and builds public trust through authentic coverage.

III. It serves as a **cost-effective marketing tool** that provides wide exposure without additional expenses.

IV. It contributes to **reputation management** and strengthens relationships with stakeholders.

➤ **Difference Between Publicity and Advertising**

I. Publicity is **unpaid and uncontrolled**, whereas advertising is **paid and controlled**.

II. Advertising focuses on **persuasion**, while publicity focuses on **information sharing and credibility**.

III. Publicity often reaches audiences through **news stories, press releases, and media reports**, while advertising uses **paid channels like TV, radio, or print**.

➤ **Types of Advertising (List)**

I. Product Advertising

II. Institutional Advertising

III. Informative Advertising

IV. Persuasive Advertising

- V. Reminder Advertising
- VI. Comparative Advertising
- VII. Reinforcement Advertising

➤ **Explanation of Any Three Types of Advertising**

I. Product Advertising

- **Definition:** Product advertising aims to promote a specific product or service to increase consumer demand.
- **Objective:** To inform and persuade customers by highlighting product features and benefits.
- **Example:** Samsung promotes its Galaxy smartphones through online ads demonstrating unique camera features.
- **Importance:** It boosts product visibility and influences purchase decisions effectively.

II. Institutional Advertising

- **Definition:** This type of advertising focuses on building a positive image of the organisation rather than a particular product.
- **Objective:** To create goodwill, enhance brand reputation, and build trust among the public.
- **Example:** Infosys runs institutional advertisements showcasing its corporate values and community initiatives.
- **Importance:** It helps in developing long-term credibility and brand loyalty.

III. Reminder Advertising

- **Definition:** Reminder advertising is used to keep a brand fresh in consumers' minds even after its initial popularity.
- **Objective:** To maintain customer engagement and encourage repeat purchases.
- **Example:** Amul regularly releases witty print ads to remind audiences about its long-standing brand presence.
- **Importance:** It sustains brand recall and reinforces consumer connection.

➤ **Significance of Publicity and Advertising**

- I. Both are integral to promoting products and enhancing market visibility.
- II. Publicity provides authenticity, while advertising ensures consistent communication.

III. Their combined use enhances awareness, reputation, and profitability.

Conclusion

Publicity and advertising together form the backbone of modern marketing communication. While publicity enhances **credibility through unpaid exposure**, advertising ensures **control and consistency of messaging**. The different types of advertising, such as product, institutional, and reminder advertising, contribute to shaping consumer perceptions, maintaining engagement, and driving long-term brand success.

Q6. Write a note on Ethics in Marketing.

Ans :- MEANING AND SIGNIFICANCE OF ETHICS IN MARKETING

➤ Meaning of Ethics in Marketing

Ethics in marketing refers to the **application of moral principles and values** in the process of creating, promoting, and delivering products or services. It ensures that marketing activities are conducted fairly, truthfully, and responsibly, maintaining respect for consumers and society.

Ethical marketing focuses on transparency, integrity, and accountability. It aims not only to satisfy customer needs but also to contribute positively to society and uphold the reputation of the organisation.

➤ Importance of Ethics in Marketing

I. It helps in **building consumer trust** by ensuring honesty and transparency in business practices.

II. It improves **brand reputation and credibility** in a competitive marketplace.

III. It promotes **long-term customer loyalty** through fair dealings and genuine communication.

IV. It prevents **legal issues and penalties** by aligning marketing activities with ethical and legal standards.

V. It strengthens the organisation's **social responsibility** and corporate image.

➤ Principles of Ethical Marketing

I. Honesty and Fairness

- Marketers must provide true and complete information about products and avoid deceptive

advertising.

- Ethical communication helps customers make informed decisions.

II. Transparency in Dealings

- Companies should be open about product pricing, quality, and limitations.
- Transparency fosters trust and maintains goodwill among customers.

III. Respect for Consumer Privacy

- Organisations must handle customer data securely and avoid misuse of personal information.
- Data collection practices should be transparent and consent-based.

IV. Social and Environmental Responsibility

- Ethical marketing promotes sustainable practices and discourages harm to the environment.
- Example: Companies using eco-friendly packaging or supporting social causes.

V. Avoiding Manipulative Tactics

- Marketers must not exploit emotions or spread misinformation to influence buying behaviour.
- Honest representation ensures long-term brand loyalty.

➤ Examples of Ethical Marketing Practices

I. Tata Group focuses on integrity and social welfare, embedding ethics into every marketing initiative.

II. The Body Shop campaigns for cruelty-free beauty products and fair trade sourcing.

III. Patagonia promotes environmental sustainability through responsible advertising.

➤ Challenges in Implementing Marketing Ethics

I. Intense competition may push firms towards **unethical shortcuts** to increase profits.

II. **Cultural variations** make it difficult to apply uniform ethical standards globally.

III. Pressure to meet **sales targets** can lead to exaggerated or false advertising.

IV. The rise of **digital marketing** poses privacy concerns and data misuse risks.

Conclusion

Ethics in marketing plays a crucial role in ensuring fairness, transparency, and accountability in business practices. By prioritising integrity and social responsibility, organisations not only gain customer trust but also achieve sustainable success. Ethical marketing creates a **balance between profit-making and societal welfare**, establishing long-term goodwill and corporate excellence.